

CHZZK Streamer Channel Diagnosis

Advisor Review Request (Part 1)

Anonymous CHZZK streamer — general game + virtual hybrid, ~700 followers
Analysis period: 2024 Q1 – 2026 Q2 | 585 broadcast sessions | Core cohort: 323 channels

Date: 2026-06-17 v2 Prepared by: Streamer Consulting Project Review time: 60–90 min

§1. What This Analysis Claims

Domain context: CHZZK is South Korea's primary live-streaming platform, launched in late 2023 as Naver's successor to its previous streaming service. The general-game category contains several thousand active channels. A channel with ~700 followers and a peak of 20 concurrent viewers sits in the lower-mid tier — comparable to a small independent content creator building an audience from the ground up.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This channel has grown steadily over two years (avg viewers +57%, peak +50%, chat engagement +201%). Within its peer cohort, it ranks in the upper-mid range for audience scale (71st percentile) but broadcasts at the absolute maximum volume (112h/month, 100th percentile). There is a weak negative correlation between broadcast hours and viewer output across the peer band ($r = -0.315$), suggesting that more volume may not translate to more audience. The central recommendation is to test broadcast intensity optimization rather than continue adding volume.

Three Claims That Need Your Scrutiny

1 The cohort is the right comparison set.

Peak-based filtering (peak 12–45) across two categories (general game + virtual) → dual-category cohort of 323 channels. This is a design choice with trade-offs.

2 Efficiency is average, not above average.

Raw efficiency percentile (59.8%) overstates true efficiency due to a size effect. After log-log regression adjustment, the subject sits near the regression line.

3 Broadcast volume has diminishing returns.

The negative correlation ($r = -0.315$) is cross-sectional and could reflect reverse causality. Used to recommend intensity optimization, not volume reduction.

§2. What I Need You to Review

Estimated review time: 60-90 minutes. If time is limited, Q1 and Q6 are highest priority.

For each question, I'm asking: "What would you do differently?" — not "Is this OK?"

Q1 If you received this hybrid general-game/virtual streamer case, what would be the first thing you'd change about the cohort design (dual-category, peak-filtered, $n=323$)?

HIGH PRIORITY If the cohort is wrong, all percentiles and peer comparisons are wrong.

Q2 We excluded sessions $\geq 14h$ as outliers (603 sessions, 2.5%). If you were designing the exclusion rule, what method would you use?

NORMAL The exclusion affects the broadcast-volume analysis (§6, Q6) directly.

Q3 For goal-range estimation we use observed band medians (primary) supplemented by regression extrapolation ($R^2 \sim 0.38$). At what R^2 would you stop using regression?

NORMAL Goal-range estimates feed the client-facing growth roadmap. Overconfident ranges mislead.

Q4 The subject's percentile drops from 71.7% (T1) to 44.9% (T2), a 27pp gap. We attribute this to T2 channels being larger. Would you normalize, or is the raw gap the correct signal?

NORMAL Determines whether the subject is "upper-mid" or "mid" depending on the reference frame.

Q5 Retention (0.712, 86th %ile) is presented as a strength, but roughly half comes from peak being –15% below regression prediction. How would you frame this to the client?

NORMAL The client currently believes retention is a confirmed strength. If it's partly an artifact of weak peak, the narrative changes.

Q6 The negative correlation ($r = -0.315$, $n=197$) is our central actionable finding. What would be the first analysis you'd run to separate selection effect from causal effect?

HIGH PRIORITY If it's selection (low-audience streamers compensate with more hours), the recommendation reverses.

Deliverable format: For each Q, I'd find most useful: (a) your alternative approach, (b) severity of the issue (blocks conclusion / weakens it / cosmetic), (c) one sentence on what you'd tell the client differently. Beyond Q1-Q6, any additional observations are welcome.

§3. Method Decision Log

Key design choices and the alternatives considered. This is where I'm most uncertain and where your expertise matters most.

Decision	Chosen	Rejected Alternative	Why I Chose This	What I'm Unsure About
Cohort filter metric	peak_recent_median 12-45	follower-based (300-2000)	Follower counts include inactive/inflated accounts. Peak reflects actual concurrent audience.	Whether the 12-45 window is too narrow or too wide. No sensitivity table yet.
Dual-category design	T1 (general game) + T2 (virtual) as separate cohorts	Single merged cohort	Subject operates in both. Merging would hide population composition difference.	Whether the T1/T2 split creates more confusion than clarity.
Efficiency metric	peak / follower	avg/follower, viewership/follower	Peak is less affected by broadcast length than avg.	Whether peak/follower is standard or idiosyncratic to our framework.
Outlier exclusion	Fixed 14h per session	IQR-based per-channel, no exclusion	14h+ sessions are overwhelmingly overnight unattended streams. Simpler, more transparent.	Whether per-channel IQR would change conclusions materially.
Regression model	log-log (efficiency ~ follower)	Linear, polynomial, quantile	Power-law relationship in scatter. Log-log linearizes cleanly ($R^2 = 0.788$).	Forward regressions ($R^2 \sim 0.38$) are weak — supplementary only.
Broadcast-volume finding	"Single most actionable finding"	"Observed pattern, further testing needed"	$r = -0.315$ consistent across peer band; subject at extreme.	Whether "most actionable" overstates confidence given cross-sectional data.

§4. Evidence: Cohort Design and Data

4.1 Cohort Structure

Pool	n	Purpose	Used In
T1 (main)	184	Primary benchmark: CHZZK general game, peak 12–45	Percentiles, regression, positioning
T2 (aux)	196	Virtual benchmark: CHZZK virtual, peak 12–45	Cross-cohort robustness, T1↔T2 gap
Overlap	57	Channels in both T1 and T2	Hybrid subgroup analysis
Core unique	323	T1 ∪ T2 (deduplicated)	Primary analytical universe
Upper band (ref)	271	Followers 3K–10K, multi-category, peak 12–45	Growth projections beyond current tier
Enrichment-only	266	Profile data only, no broadcast records	Profile enrichment denominator
Total profiled	860	All channels with profile data	Profile-level summaries only
Broadcast pool	309 / 24,056	Channels with broadcast data collected	Broadcast-level analyses

Note: The "860" figure refers to the total profiled universe (323 + 271 + 266), not the analytical cohort. Core analyses use the 323-channel cohort or the 309-channel broadcast pool.

4.2 Data Collection

Item	Detail
Broadcast records	309 channels, 24,056 sessions
Outlier exclusion	Sessions ≥ 14 h removed: 603 sessions (2.5%). Fixed threshold, uniform.
Subject data	585 sessions (2024.02–2026.06), 226 daily stats
Collection tool	Softcon viewership platform (automated browser collection)
Success rate	95.7% (14 channels failed)
Profile enrichment	965/965 channels via Softcon + CHZZK API

4.3 Known Collection Limitations

Failed channels: 14 channels (4.3%) failed during automated collection. These had a lower median peak (14) compared to successful channels (18), introducing possible small-channel underrepresentation. We cannot fully rule out that this biases cohort percentiles upward.

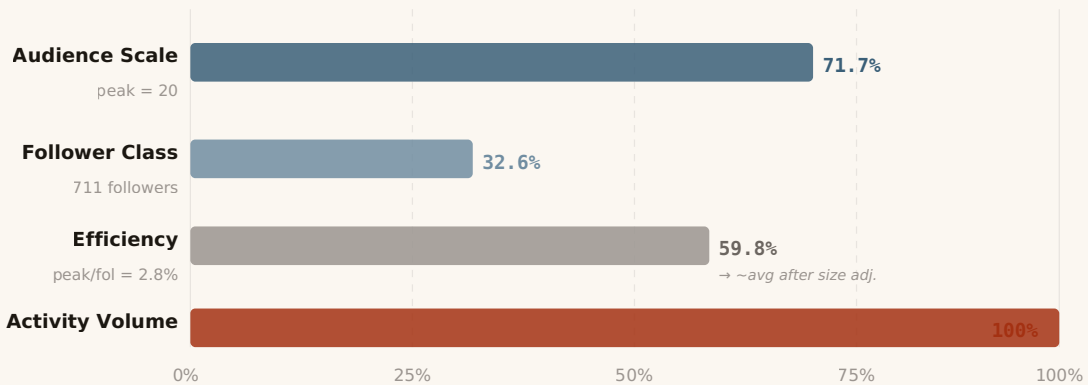
Temporal mismatch: Cohort broadcast records cover 2026 Q1-Q2 only. The subject has data from 2024 Q1. Long-term growth-rate comparisons between subject and cohort are therefore not possible — we compare current-state positioning only.

§5. Evidence: Statistical Methods

5.1 Multi-axis Positioning

Subject sits upper-mid on audience but at maximum broadcast volume

4-axis percentile positioning within T1 cohort (n=184)



Source: Softcon viewership / T1 n=184 / 2026 Q1-Q2 / Activity volume = exposure axis, not performance

Efficiency size adjustment: Raw efficiency percentile (59.8%) includes a structural size effect — smaller channels naturally show higher peak/follower ratios. The log-log regression residual is -0.039 in log-space, placing the subject near the regression line. Efficiency is approximately average for a channel at this follower level.

5.2 Log-log Regression

Cohort	Model	Slope	R ²	p-value	n
T1	$\log(\text{eff}) \sim \log(\text{follower})$	-0.804	0.788	3.9e-63	184
T2	$\log(\text{eff}) \sim \log(\text{follower})$	-0.766	0.749	1.4e-59	196

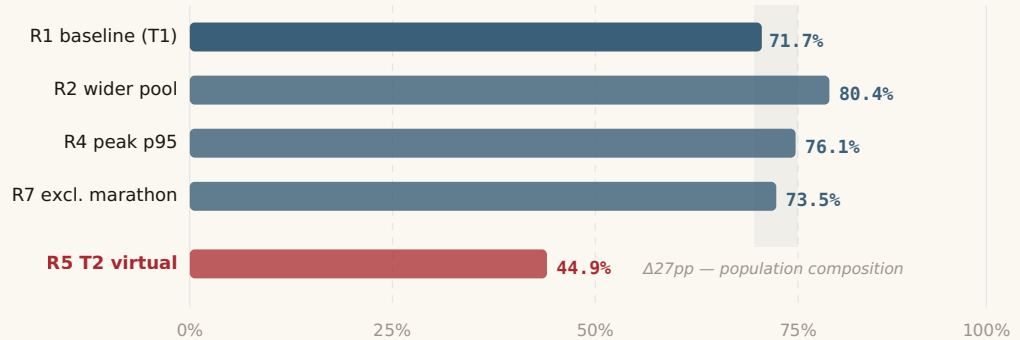
Interpretation: A 10× increase in followers corresponds to efficiency dropping to approximately 0.16×.

Forward regressions for goal-range estimation: $\log(\text{peak}) \sim \log(\text{follower})$ $R^2=0.39$, $\log(\text{avg}) \sim \log(\text{follower})$ $R^2=0.37$. Substantially lower explanatory power — supplementary estimates only.

5.3 Robustness Checks

Subject percentile is stable at 71-76% within T1 variants; T2 gap = population effect

Percentile across robustness variants



Source: Softcon viewership / Various pool variants / Shaded band = T1 stability range (71-76%)

5.4 Retention

0.712

Retention (avg/peak)

86th %ile

on line

Avg vs. regression

As expected

-15%

Peak vs. regression

Below predicted

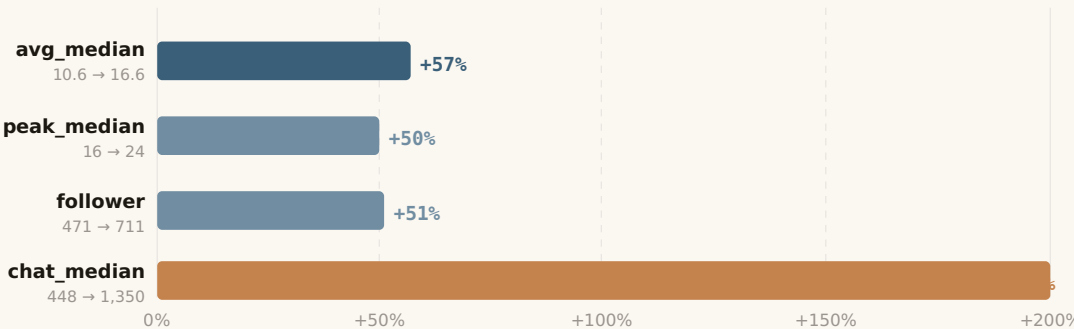
Mixed signal: Roughly half the retention strength comes from avg being normal while peak is slightly depressed. Present as "*stable average viewership combined with below-expected peak*" rather than a confirmed strength in isolation.

§6. Evidence: Key Quantitative Findings

6.1 Growth Trajectory

All four metrics grew concurrently over two years; chat engagement led at +201%

2024 Q1 → 2026 Q2 change rate



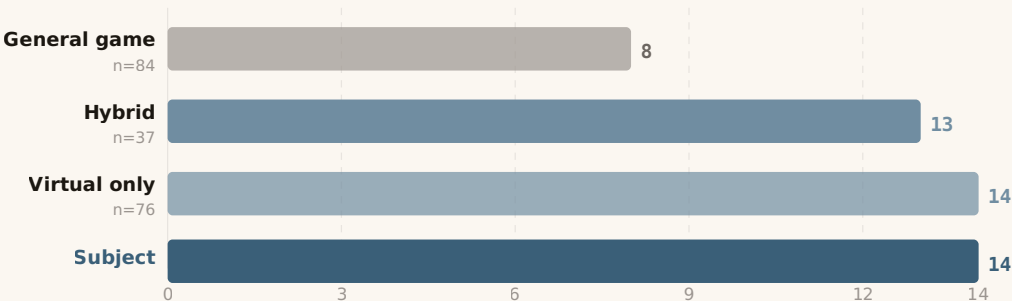
Source: Softcon viewership / Subject 585 sessions / *Chat baseline is 2024 Q2 (Q1 data unavailable)

Avg growth (+57%) slightly outpaces peak and follower growth (+50–51%), consistent with improving viewer retention over time. A notable dip occurred in 2025 Q1 (peak 20→16, –20%) followed by recovery and acceleration into 2026.

6.2 Peer Comparison

Subject matches hybrid group median (avg 14); hybrid channels outperform general-game-only

Follower 500–1,500 band / avg_median comparison



Source: Softcon viewership / Follower 500–1,500 band / Not adjusted for follower distribution, broadcast volume, or survivorship

6.3 Broadcast Volume

$r = -0.315$

Hours vs. avg_median
 $p < 0.001$, $n=197$

112h

Monthly broadcast hours
100th %ile (max)

1.3x

Output vs. cohort median
Diminishing returns

What this finding supports: Testing whether marginal hours contribute to audience growth before adding more volume. Analyzing output per hour in different time slots and session lengths.

What this finding does NOT support: A causal claim that reducing hours will increase viewership, or a blanket recommendation against current broadcast volume. The correlation is cross-sectional.

§7. Consolidated Limitations

- 1 Peak 12–45 window excludes sub-12 micro-streamers and 45+ mid-tier channels. Growth projections beyond ~5,000 followers rely on upper-band reference data ($n=271$), not the core cohort.
- 2 14 failed channels (4.3%) skew smaller, possibly inflating cohort percentiles. Sensitivity analysis pending.
- 3 Cohort broadcast records cover 2026 Q1–Q2 only. No longitudinal growth-rate comparison with cohort.
- 4 Forward regressions ($R^2 \sim 0.38$) are weak. Used as supplementary estimates only.
- 5 T1↔T2 percentile comparison is raw (not follower-adjusted).
- 6 Retention is a mixed signal (avg normal + peak depressed), not a pure strength.
- 7 Broadcast-volume correlation is cross-sectional. Causality direction unresolved.
- 8 Peer comparison (§6.2) is not adjusted for within-group distribution differences.
- 9 Regression table does not include SE, CI, or residual diagnostics in this version.

Appendix A: Pool Dictionary

Pool Name	n	Source	Filter	Role in Analysis
T1 main	184	CHZZK general game	peak 12-45	Primary cohort
T2 aux	196	CHZZK virtual	peak 12-45	Cross-cohort robustness
Overlap	57	T1 ∩ T2	—	Hybrid subgroup
Core unique	323	T1 ∪ T2	—	Analytical universe
Upper band	271	Multi-category	fol 3K-10K, peak 12-45	Growth projection ref
Enrichment-only	266	Various	Profile match only	Profile context only
Total profiled	860	All above	—	Profile-level universe
Broadcast pool	309 / 24,056	Broadcast data subset	Collection success	Broadcast analyses
Subject	1 / 585	Target channel	2024.02-2026.06	Diagnosis target

Appendix B: Metric Definitions

Metric	Formula	Window	Note
peak_recent_median	median(per-session peak viewers)	Most recent quarter	Cohort filter and audience scale axis
avg_median	median(per-session avg viewers)	Per quarter	Growth trajectory metric
follower	Absolute follower count	Snapshot	From daily stats, not broadcast CSV
retention	mean of quarterly [median(avg)/median(peak)]	2026 Q1-Q2	Not a per-session ratio
efficiency	peak_recent_median / follower	At analysis date	Size-adjusted via regression residual
monthly hours	quarterly total hours / 3, averaged	Rolling quarterly	Not a calendar 30-day window
viewership	avg_median × monthly hours	Derived	Volume-weighted output

v1 → v2 Change Log

Change	Rationale
Added §1 Executive Summary with domain context	Advisor needs scale context for CHZZK and the 700-follower tier
Restructured: conclusions first, then evidence	Advisor can read §1–§2 (5 min) and selectively dive into evidence
Added §3 Method Decision Log	Shows rejected alternatives — most useful input for expert review
Reframed Q1–Q6 as "what would you change"	Elicits expert alternatives rather than yes/no validation
Fixed pool 860 definition (P-01)	§2.1 and Appendix now consistent; pool dictionary added
Clarified outlier method (P-02)	14h fixed, IQR available but not applied; relationship explicit
Softened selection bias language (P-03)	"no bias detected" → "cannot fully rule out"
Fixed "exactly average" (P-05)	→ "approximately average for a channel at this follower level"
Softened hybrid advantage (P-10)	"clear" → "observed in raw within-band comparison"
Softened broadcast-volume recommendation (P-11)	Separated supports vs. does not support
Added metric definitions (P-20)	monthly hours 112h, retention 0.712 window definitions explicit
Added §7 Consolidated Limitations	Previously scattered; now one scannable list
Activity volume reframed as exposure axis (P-13)	100th percentile not presented as strength

End of Part 1 review packet. Part 2 (§6 goal-range estimation, §7 content analysis, §8 action plan) to follow separately.